

VTAM — Verified Trust Attribution Module

Parent Standard: Trust Layer Standard

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Verified Trust Attribution

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Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Trust Layer Standard · Truth Validation Layer · Integrity Standard · Universal Canonical Language · Origin-Bound Identity · Audit in Real Time · AI Runtime Integrity Vault

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English

Canonical Definition

Verified Trust Attribution Module defines the structural conditions under which trust may be validly attributed to a system, entity, process, environment, workflow, or operational actor only when that trust-state is linked to traceable evidence, bounded verification conditions, accountable identity continuity, and reviewable operational behavior.

A system satisfies VTAM only if:

- trust attribution is explicitly bounded
- trust is linked to a defined object, entity, or operational scope
- attributed trust can be traced to evidence and verification conditions
- trust is not falsely generalized beyond what was actually validated
- attribution remains reconstructable across time, state change, and operational context

A system that attributes trust vaguely, symbolically, or beyond its verified scope does not satisfy VTAM.

Module Function

VTAM defines the attribution layer of trust architecture.

It ensures that trust is not treated as a free-floating label, reputational halo, or broad symbolic status, but as something attributed only where verification, identity continuity, and structural evidence justify that attribution.

The module applies wherever trust is assigned to:

- systems
- institutions
- entities
- AI agents

- workflows
- operational environments
- infrastructure components
- decision processes
- inter-system relationships

Its function is to answer a critical question:

- **Who or what is trusted, under which conditions, on what evidence, and within what verified scope?**

Step 1 — Define the Attribution Object

The organization must define the exact object to which trust is being attributed.

Minimum requirement:

- the attribution object is explicit
- the object is distinguishable from surrounding entities or systems
- undefined trust targets are excluded from valid attribution logic

The attribution object may be a:

- system
- module
- process
- workflow
- entity
- AI agent
- operational environment
- interface or interaction boundary

Step 2 — Define Attribution Boundaries

The system must define the exact scope within which trust attribution is valid.

Minimum requirement:

- trust attribution boundaries are explicit
- verified trust is not extended beyond its evidence base
- partial trust is not represented as universal trust

This means the system must prevent false expansion such as:

- trusting one module as if the whole system were verified
- trusting one environment as if all environments were covered
- trusting one state as if trust remained valid across all future changes

Step 3 — Define Attribution Evidence

The system must define what evidence supports trust attribution.

Minimum requirement:

- attribution evidence is explicit
- trust is linked to reviewable validation conditions
- unsupported attribution is excluded from valid trust logic

Evidence may include:

- trust verification results
- runtime validation records
- audit evidence
- identity continuity records
- integrity-state confirmation
- traceable execution history
- canonical meaning consistency evidence

Step 4 — Define Attribution Logic

The system must define how trust is assigned from evidence to the attribution object.

Minimum requirement:

- attribution logic is explicit
- trust attribution is not based on vague association alone
- the path from evidence to attributed trust remains reviewable

This means the system must be able to explain:

- why trust is attributed
- to whom or to what
- under which validated conditions
- within what boundaries
- for what operational purpose

Step 5 — Define Identity Continuity of Attribution

The system must define how trust attribution remains linked to stable identity over time.

Minimum requirement:

- attribution remains attached to a traceable identity
- trust does not silently transfer across unrelated identities

- broken continuity invalidates unsupported trust carryover

Without identity continuity, trust attribution can become misleading, misplaced, or falsely inherited.

Step 6 — Preserve Attribution Traceability

The system must preserve traceability of trust attribution itself.

Minimum requirement:

- attribution events are reviewable
- evidence and trust assignment remain reconstructable
- later audit can identify how attribution was established and whether it remained valid

If trust attribution cannot be reconstructed, then the system cannot distinguish verified trust from attributed assumption.

Step 7 — Restrict Invalid Trust Attribution

The system must not be treated as valid if trust is attributed vaguely, inherited without evidence, extended beyond scope, or detached from identity continuity.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid attribution conditions are identifiable
 - symbolic trust carryover is excluded
 - structurally unsupported attribution is blocked or invalidated
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Scenario

An organization validates a specific AI decision component and wants to attribute trust only to that verified part without falsely extending trust to the entire surrounding system.

Application

VTAM is used to ensure:

- the trust object is explicitly defined
 - trust attribution remains bounded to the validated component
 - evidence for attribution is traceable
 - trust is not generalized beyond what was actually verified
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Result

The organization gains a stronger trust architecture in which trust attribution remains precise rather than inflated by reputation or system association.

Scenario

Several organizations or operational actors participate in one governed environment, and trust must be attributed correctly across entities, processes, and responsibilities.

Application

VTAM is used to ensure:

- trust is attributed only where evidence supports it
 - each entity or process remains distinguishable
 - attribution does not drift through vague collective reputation
 - identity continuity and verification scope remain preserved
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Result

The environment gains a stronger basis for trusted cooperation because trust attribution becomes structurally precise, reviewable, and evidence-linked.

Canonical Closing Statement

If trust cannot be attributed with bounded evidence and identity continuity, it becomes reputation spread rather than verified trust.

Related Documents

→ [Trust Layer Standard \(TLS™\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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